

How LLMs Think

Hint: it's just **Antakshari**

Remember playing **Antakshari** at family functions? The next song starts with the last letter of the previous one.



Ha, yes! Someone sings "...gaata hoon," and the next person scrambles for a song starting with "N."



Notice — nobody plans the whole session in advance. Each person looks at the last sound and picks the best next song they know.



True. Nobody says "I have a 10-song strategy." It's one move at a time.





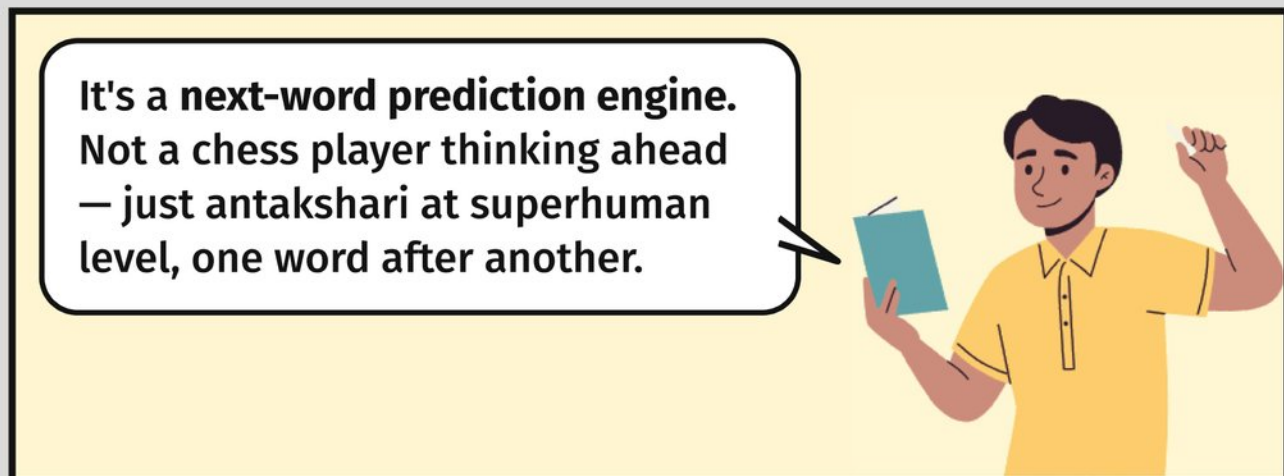
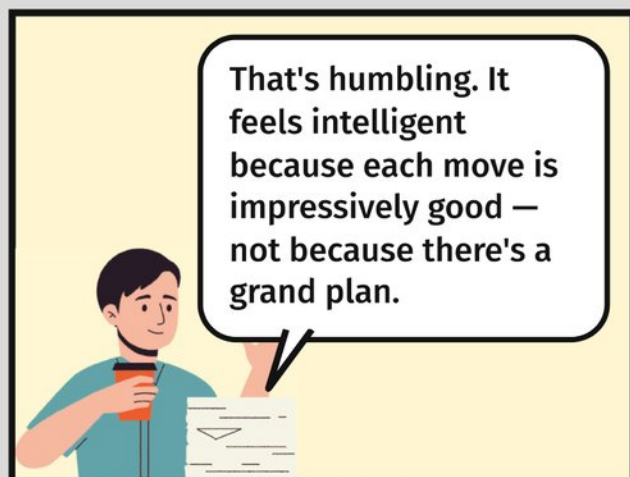
That one move — picking the next best song based on what came before — is exactly what an LLM does. Only its unit isn't a song, it's a word.
Actually, even smaller: a piece of a word, called a **token**.

Wait — so it's not "thinking" of the full answer first and then writing it out?

No plan, no destination. It looks at everything said so far, asks "**what usually comes next?**" — and picks that.

So if I ask it to write an email, it's not thinking "**here's my conclusion, let me build up to it?**"





That's the whole trick. No goal, no plan — just really, really good next-move prediction, repeated until it looks like thought.

**TAKEAWAY**

An LLM doesn't plan answers. It predicts the next token — again and again.